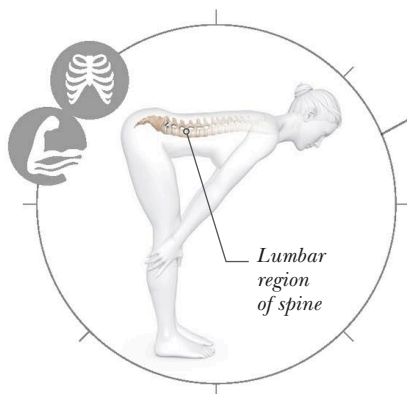
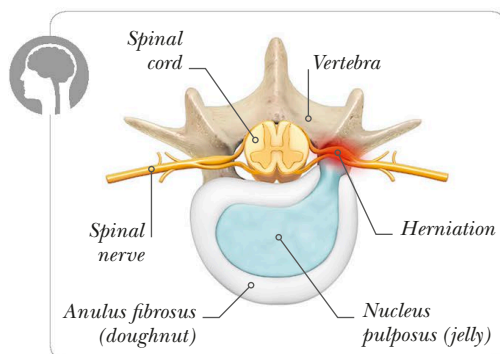


» CLOSER LOOK

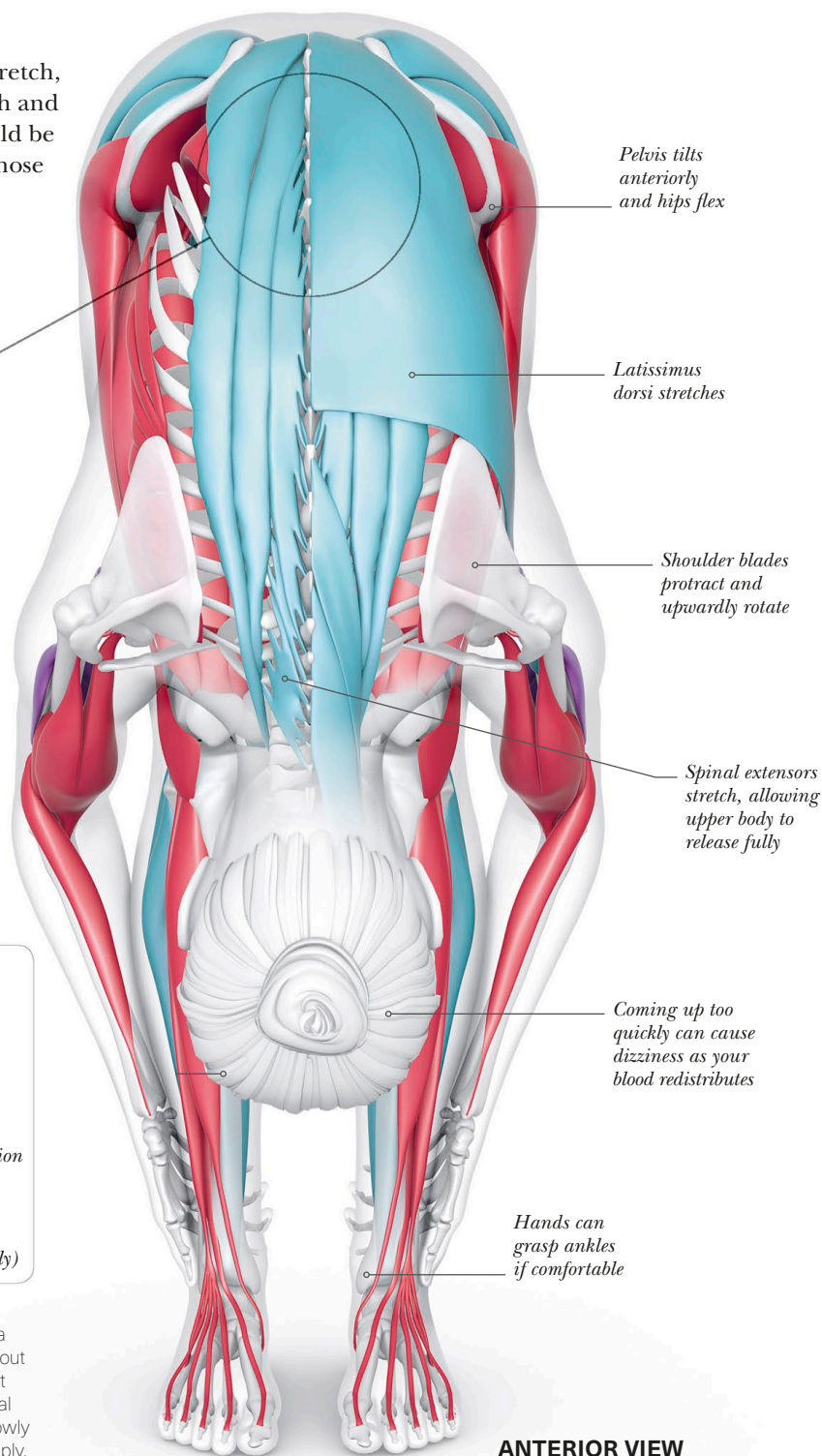
Forward Fold delivers a deep spinal stretch, which can help to improve back health and reduce back pain. However, care should be taken to reduce the lumbar load for those with intervertebral disk issues.

**Lumbar load**

The load on the lumbar spine in a standing Forward Fold is significant. The lower back is particularly vulnerable during the transition in and out of the pose. If you have any back pain, arthritis, disk issues, osteopenia, or osteoporosis, try keeping your spine neutral and transition in and out of the pose with bent knees and an engaged core.

**Herniated disk**

Intervertebral disks are like jelly doughnuts. In a "slipped" or herniated disk, the "jam" partially leaks out of the tougher fibrocartilage "dough." Since most herniations occur posterior-laterally due to spinal flexion, if you currently have a disk issue, move slowly or avoid flexion by not going into the pose as deeply.

**ANTERIOR VIEW**